

Guidance VMPR mapping into the legislative commodity groups

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INTRODUCTION

This document provides for a short description of the mapping carried out by EFSA from the MTX FoodEx2 codes into the main VMPR legislative commodity groups: Aquaculture, bovines, pigs, sheep, goats, horses, poultry, milk, eggs, rabbits, farmed game, wild game, honey, casings, reptiles and insects.

The assignment or 'flagging' into one of the legislative commodities is performed via different mappings that run during the EFSA ETL (Extract, Transform and Load) processing of the datasets which will create the necessary columns associated to each tested sample in the EFSA scientific Data Warehouse (sDWH).

In order to facilitate the implementation of the different VMPR mappings into the national systems, the current document provides the logic behind.

BACKGROUND AND GENERAL PROCESS

The information on the laboratory samples is transmitted to EFSA via a specific data element of the Standard Sample Description v2 (SSD2): Coded description of the matrix of the sample taken (sampMatCode). The information is coded using the MTX (FoodEx2) catalogue¹ which contains a complex list of alphanumerical codes that are combinations of based terms and facets. In the context of VMPR, the list of allowed based terms is already restricted via the use of a specific hierarchy in the catalogue (VetDrugRes hierarchy).

However, EFSA identified the need to establish an easy mapping between all the different and possible combinations of the reported FoodEx2 code to the 16 VMPR commodity groups. The mappings should account for any combinations of based term and facets, and for any possible change in the catalogue.

There are three mappings to consider: 1) the identification of a farmed game sample, 2) the VMPR Food Classifier tool run in the context of the Legal Limit Database (LLDB), 3) the identification of the hunted game samples, 4) and the classification to one of the 16 VMPR commodity groups.

GAME SAMPLES

The first step of these mappings is to identify if the coded samples are to be considered Game (wild or hunted). A specific set of source facets (F01) for game samples were identified after requests coming from the national data providers and are presented in the following table in the same order of the mapping:

Source code (F01)	Name
A056T	Chamois (as animal)
A056V	Mouflon (as animal)
A056X	Hare (as animal)
A056Y	Wild boar (as animal)

¹ European Food Safety Authority, 2015. The food classification and description system FoodEx2 (revision 2). EFSA supporting publication 2015:EN-804. 90 pp. Further updates and guides are available here: <https://www.efsa.europa.eu/en/data/data-standardisation>



Source code (F01)	Name
A056M	Deer (as animal)
A0F2A	Camelidae (camelids) (as animal)
A0CTQ	Peccari (collared) (as animal)
A0CSP	Steinbock (as animal)
A16NY	Musk ox (as animal)
A0CSY	Struthioniformes (as animal)
A16CF	Barbary sheep (as animal)
A16DL	Mountain goat (as animal)
A056L	Game or wild mammals (as animal)
A169S	Ruminants (generic) (as animal)
A16BX	Antelopes (as animal)

In the processing of the data, a column called *Game* is created. When the mentioned sources facets (F01) are explicitly or implicitly included in the base term, the column is automatically filled up with a '1' while the rest will remain with a '0'.

VMPR FOOD CLASSIFIER

The VMPR Food Classifier (VMPR FoodClass) was created in order to map all the different codes combinations from FoodEx2 to the matrices present in Reg. 37/2010 and new categories added with the introduction of Reg. 2022/1646. This is a first step before reaching the mapping to the main legislative categories.

This VMPR FoodClass is published in the LLDB to identify the MRL applied to each tested matrix. The FoodClass takes into account different facets:

- Source facet (F01) to identify the species e.g. A057E "Cattle (as animal)"
- Part-nature (F02) to identify the product e.g. A069M "Liver (as part-nature)"
- Part-consumed analysed (F20) only applicable for meat as muscle excludes the fat. The code to be used is A0F4V "Excluding visible fat"
- Target consumer (F23) to identify the intended animals in case of feed and water samples e.g. A18DN "Calves feed"
- Legislative classes (F33) used in the context of processed products for which the data providers specify to EFSA the legislative commodity to be assigned to the sample e.g. A1ANZ "VR – Eggs"

In the processing of the data, a column called *FoodClassVMPR* is created which is filled up with codes from the hierarchy vmprLL from the MTXCLS catalogue. Game samples are always assigned to the code M020A for 'Other products' with the exception of Ratites as some limits are defined in Reg. 37/2010. Even if the column *FoodClassVMPR* is filled up with a different code, a value of '1' in the column *Game* will supersede it. More information is available in the chapter on the Main VMPR Legislative Commodities.

The FoodClass contains a mapping order, which means that if the sampMatCode complies with the first line, it will not move forward and will be assign the first code. If no match is found, it will move to the second line to see if there is a match.



EFSA updates every year if needed the table behind the FoodClass. This table can be either downloaded from the LLDB tool or from the Zenodo² publication in order to be ingested into the national systems.

WILD GAME SAMPLES

In the processing of the data, a column called *Wild* is created. This column is filled up with a '1' when production method (F21) is A07RY "Wild or gathered or hunted". This applies to the sources mentioned as Game but also to any fish (e.g. salmon) or poultry (e.g. pheasant) for which the data provider has explicitly reported as hunted.

MAIN VMPR LEGISLATIVE COMMODITY GROUPS

This is the last mapping used in VMPR. It considers the information of the columns *Game*, *Wild* and *FoodClassVMPR*.

In the processing of the data, a column called *FoodClassVMPR_report* is created which is filled up with codes from the hierarchy vmprCls from the MTXCLS catalogue.

The mapping contains different steps in the following order:

1. If the column *Wild* contains a '1', then the new column will be filled up with the code MC008A "Game (Wild Game)".
2. If the column *Game* contains a '1', then the new column will be filled up with the code MC007A "Game (Farmed Game)". *Consider that this step should be included after the wild as in some cases, both columns will be equal to '1'. The identification as wild will always supersede the information on the other columns.*
3. The rest of the samples will be assigned to different commodities based in the column *FoodClassVMPR*. In order to implement a quick mapping, the parent-child structure of the MTXCLS catalogue was considered. As an example, all the matrices related to bovine are under the code MC251A "Bovine" in the vmprLL hierarchy. As such, only the parent is needed for the mapping. However, some exceptions should be considered first in the mapping order: eggs and milk should always be mapped first as they are included under the parent of the animal (e.g. Bovine). The following table contains the combination of codes between both columns:

FoodClassVMPR Name	FoodClassVMPR_report
MC207A Turkey – Egg	MC002A Eggs
MC215A Poultry – Egg	
MC228A Chicken – Egg	
MC308A Reptiles – Eggs	
MC449A Turkey - Egg and egg-related	
MC451A Chicken - Egg and egg-related	
MC453A Poultry - Egg and egg-related	
MC475A Egg and egg products	MC001A Milk
MC234A Equidae - Milk	

² European Food Safety Authority. EFSA Legal Limit Data Base for compliance check of chemical monitoring data. Zenodo – Knowledge Junction. Available online: <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11126756>



FoodClassVMPR Name	FoodClassVMPR_report
MC241A Ovine - Milk	
MC248A Caprine – Milk	
MC256A Bovine - Milk	
MC442A Bovine - Dairy products	
MC457A Equidae - Dairy products	
MC459A Caprine - Dairy products	
MC461A Ovine - Dairy products	
MC476A Dairy products	
MC463A Bee - Apiculture products	MC003A Honey
MC291A Casings	MC291A Casings
MC290A Insects	MC290A Insects
MC289A Reptiles	MC289A Reptiles
MC184A Fish and any other Marine and Freshwater products	MC005A Aquaculture
MC177A Poultry and Ratites	MC012A Poultry
MC229A Equidae	MC010A Horses
MC195A Rabbit	MC013A Rabbits
MC178A Porcine	MC011A Pigs
MC251A Bovine	MC006A Bovines
MC243A Caprine	MC009A Goats
MC236A Ovine	MC014A Sheep

In the context of the VMPR EU Annual Report, the legislative commodity groups of Sheep and Goats are considered together.